

How the website was designed, and why

The thinking behind the site in a few minutes, rather than the twenty-five page build specification it came from.

THE JOB

To make a contractor look like a firm, to someone who has already heard the name.

Almost nobody will find this site by searching. They will get your name from a referral, an architect, or a WhatsApp thread — and then check whether you are real and serious before they call. That check is the whole job of the site.

So it is built as a **credential**, not a shop window. Success is not visitor numbers. It is that the enquiries get better, and that you are invited to quote for larger work.

THE IDEA

The site is a setting-out drawing.

Landscape practices work in plan before they work in ground. Your own positioning is *design first*; your Instagram highlight is *Render / Reality*. So the site does not present itself as a photo gallery with words around it. It presents itself as the thing you actually produce first — a drawing.

That means fine ruled lines, a drawn garden plan, sheet numbers and a title block running through every page, the way they would on a real drawing set.

Three reasons this was chosen over a conventional photo-led site:

- **It is specific to your trade**

A restaurant could not use it. A competing landscaper could only use it by becoming a firm that draws — which is exactly the claim you are making.

- **It answers the real worry**

A prospect's anxiety is competence, not taste. A page that looks like a set of construction drawings answers that before a word is read.

- **It is light**

The whole opening screen is drawn in code rather than photographed, so it costs almost nothing to load on Nigerian mobile data.

THE SIGNATURE

The home page splits in two, on a gold hinge.

ENGLISH Landscaping The building of it.	HAUSA Alatu The keeping of it.
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Your business model drawn as a layout. It needs no photography, it says something true rather than decorative, and no competitor can copy it, because no competitor has that name.

It is the one bold moment in the site. Everything else stays quiet on purpose — boldness spent everywhere is noise.

A DELIBERATE DECISION

The shooting range is shown as proof, not as a service.

It is your largest and most impressive engagement, so the instinct is to lead with it. The site deliberately does not.

If specialist construction leads, the site starts attracting construction enquiries — work you do not want to be defined by. So the range is given weight without being given the front door: a prominent position, a status flag, the longest caption on the Work page, and the single strongest colour accent on the site. It reads as evidence that you can be trusted with the hard parts of a garden, which is precisely its value.

PHOTOGRAPHY

The site works before the photographs arrive, and improves after.

Every picture on the site sits in a prepared slot. Empty, the slot is captioned and looks intentional. Filled, the page gets better. Nothing about the layout changes.

This is why the site could be finished and shown to you before a single photograph was supplied — and why photographs can be added one at a time, whenever you have them, without any further design work.

ONE HABIT WORTH STARTING

On every new project, take three shots **from the same standing position** — before mobilisation, at structural stage, and at handover. Mark the spot so the frames line up. From three different angles you get three unrelated pictures; from one angle you get a story, and the before/after slider on the site has something real to show.

THE PAGES

Five pages, plus a page for each project you choose to write up. Separate pages rather than one long scroll, so each one is a **link you can send** — the care plans to an estate manager, a project page to a homeowner who needs convincing.

— Home

The drawing, the two halves of the business, and a short index of five projects.

— Work

The proof. Every project, with the range weighted as described above.

— Flowers

Supply and install — the colour business, and the one page built to be photograph-led.

— Care

Alatu, as a product with plans rather than a favour done between jobs.

— Studio

Who you are, how you work, and how to reach you.

Every page ends in a WhatsApp route. There is no form-and-wait path anywhere on the site, because that is not how enquiries actually happen here.

ON A PHONE

Traffic will be almost entirely mobile, arriving from WhatsApp and Instagram, on metered data. Desktop is where the craft shows, but the phone is where the business happens — and nearly every constraint in the design comes from that.

The result: the site opens in about 12 KB, scores full marks on Google's mobile checks, and is readable by someone using a screen reader. A WhatsApp button sits permanently at the bottom of the screen on every page.

WHAT YOU CAN CHANGE

Through the editor, with no developer: projects and their write-ups, the flower gallery, care plans and prices, and your contact details.

Locked, on purpose: layout, colours, typefaces, the two-panel spread, the sheet numbering and the order of sections. Those decisions are what make the site look like it was made by a firm rather than assembled — and an editor that could change them eventually would, on a Friday afternoon, with no way back.

NOT INCLUDED

Deliberately out of scope, so there is no confusion later: a blog, client logins, online payments, a booking calendar, language switching, testimonials, staff profiles, a downloadable brochure, live chat and newsletter sign-up.

None of these serve the job on page one. Each is available later if it earns its place.

WORTH MORE THAN THE WEBSITE

Four things that would return more than anything left on the site itself. Raised because they came out of the same research, not to sell further work.

01 **A company profile document**

Ten to twelve pages, procurement-ready. This is the instrument that opens institutional doors — estates, schools, hotels. A website does not do that job.

02 **Care pricing and a contract template**

Turns maintenance from an ad-hoc favour into a sold product with a renewal date. The single biggest change available to the business.

03 **The range documented properly on completion**

Photographed and written up with permission, it becomes the strongest credential you own.

04 **Instagram aligned to the site**

Same mark, same colours, same restraint, so the two reinforce one identity instead of competing.
